



Across

- 1** Owners of the #3 pick in the 2021 NBA Draft, at least for now. (9)
- 5** Where a younger Devin Booker would have gone to celebrate Suns wins (and he would've tweeted so). (9)
- 11** Initials of the forward who came off the bench in 66 games this season, after only doing so in 8 contests over the prior 17 seasons of his career. (2)
- 12** Vowels that go unused in words like kudzu, boots, and pound. (3)
- 13** Unless the WNBA or National Pro Fastpitch leagues change their postseason schedule, there will probably never be a ___ October like there is a *Mr.* (2)

- 14** The quality someone is displaying when they hate superteams but don't watch these Finals, hate flopping but love Chris Paul, or say they believe in the Bucks while betting against them. (9)

Down

- 1** Title that can be used both formally and informally for Bud, Monty, Thibs, Silas, and Daigneault. (5)
- 2** Briefly, the type of customer who gets things like courtside seats and invites to meet-and-greet sessions with team executives. (3)
- 3** Christmas, New Year's, the Garden of Eden, and ABC's "Queens" all have one of these. (3)
- 4** How you might

describe the tone Gregg Popovich, Russell Westbrook, and Rick Carlisle often use with the press, if not using the less gendered *disrespectful*. (5)

- 10** Briefly, the kind of medical professionals who attend but hope to do nothing at basketball games. (3)

- 6** One major difference between when you play basketball and when Giannis, Brook, and Khris do. (3)
- 7** Last name for Kawhi and Meyers, if you remove their *nards*. (3)
- 8** Initials for the role David Aldridge (The Athletic), Mallory Rubin (The Ringer) and yours truly (Daily Thunder) inhabit. (3)
- 9** Where hoops fans might take in the 2021 Finals, after they couldn't (safely) for the 2020 Finals. (3)